

Telephone etiquette



1. Answering a call

- First Impressions are lasting! The way a company answers the phone tells us a lot about the kind of service we can expect to receive from them. How you answer the call, sets the tone of the entire call.

The basic rules are as follows:

- a) Pick up the phone within three rings.
- b) Smile while greeting the caller.
- c) Give your company / department name and your name.
- d) Ask the customer if you can help.
- e) Pick up the phone within 3 rings. This is the general accepted standard. After the third ring, our tolerance as customers starts to waver.
- f) If you hear a phone ringing in the department in which you are working and no one picks it up, make it your business to do so. Even if you can't personally help the customer you can at least take a message and further the cause of good customer relations.

A company's answering standard should include the following:

1. Greet the customer – greeting should always be the entry point of a phone conversation because it instantly indicates your friendliness and openness to the other person. It's a kind of verbal handshake.
When answering the phone say: "Good morning/afternoon" **before** you identify yourself and the company.



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2. Identify your company and yourself – this basic courtesy lets the caller know that she has reached the correct person, department or company. Remember the caller can't see if he is at the right company or department.
3. Ask how you can help. Saying this demonstrates that you and your company are ready and available to assist the customer.
4. Use the caller's name frequently during the call. Ask the caller's name and write it down at the beginning of the conversation. This makes the caller feel that he is not just a "number".



5. Tone of voice. A smiley, lively voice is always far more welcoming than a dull, lifeless voice. Think of how you sound when you are greeting someone you want to see and how you sound when it is someone you don't like to see.



2. **Putting a caller on hold**
Activity 3

The following is a good guideline to follow when you need to put a customer on hold:

- Ask the caller if it is OK to put them on hold e.g. "Would you mind if I place you on hold?"
- Offer the customer a choice: being placed on hold, phoning back later or taking a message.
- Don't keep the caller waiting too long.
- Use hold and transfer features effectively.
- Focus on keeping the customer informed on what you are doing to help them.



1. Greetings

2. Identify yourself, company/department



3. Offer to help

4. Resolve query or

5. Ask to be placed on hold / transfer / take a message



6. Keep your promise

3. **How to transfer a call?**
Activity 4

When transferring a call:

- Explain to the customer why he is transferred, it gives the customer information and a choice.
- Give the name and number of the person you are transferring the customer to. If the customer is disconnected he can call the person directly.
- Confidential information: make sure that you know what information is confidential in your company. Don't give any employer's personal or home telephone number to a customer, unless the person gave you permission to do so.

4. **Using empathy on the telephone**

- Empathy means understanding your customer's point of view, regardless of whether or not you agree.
- Empathic phrases to practise, remember and use in a company that will make the customer feel good are:
 - "I can see why you feel that way."
 - "I see your point of view."
 - "I hear what you are saying."
 - "I am sorry it happened."



5. Taking messages
Activity 5

Provide the following when you take down a message:

- Full name and surname of the person the message is FOR.
- Full name and surname of the person the message is FROM.
- Name of the COMPANY the person is calling from.
- 2 TELEPHONE NUMBERS: cell phone and landline.
- DATE – day, month and year.
- TIME person called.
- Short but detailed MESSAGE.
- Your name and surname as the person who took the message.
- IMPORTANT: make sure the person gets the message.

6. Ending a call

- Don't underestimate the importance of ending the call on a positive note. Particularly, if the caller has been "difficult".
- Examples of how to end a call positively:
 - Both you and the customer must agree on what is going to be done. Therefore repeat the action steps you are going to take.
 - Ask the customer if you can do anything else for him.
 - Thank the customer for the call.

Activity 6: Skills practice

Activity 7: Key learning

Activity 8: Self-evaluation

Activity 9: Exercises to complete at home

ACTIVITY 1

Testing your telephone etiquette

Before we deal with the do's and don't's of telephone etiquette, let's test your current knowledge by rating each of the following scenario's as TRUE or FALSE. Only write T or F on the line.

Scenario one

It's 11:45 and Sandra is at her desk putting the final touches on her sales report, which is due at noon. She is on the final page when the phone rings. She tries to ignore it for a few moments, but the ringing continues. Eventually she picks up the phone and says with a smile: "This is Sandra, how may I help you?"

Sandra is demonstrating good telephone etiquette: _____

Scenario two

Sipho is a sales assistant at a large hardware store. His supervisor, Debra, is having a meeting with him about some new stock that has just arrived. Sipho's telephone rings. He immediately pick it up, greets the customer on the other end and politely says: "Let me put you on hold for just a minute."

Sipho is demonstrating good telephone etiquette: _____

Scenario three

Gerhard is a travel agent. His area of speciality is domestic travel. His phone rings and on the line is a customer who needs help booking an overseas trip. Gerhard explains to the customer that he does not deal with foreign travel by saying: "I am sorry, you've reached the domestic travel department, and you need to talk to international. Hold on for a moment, I will transfer you."

Gerhard is demonstrating good telephone etiquette: _____

How did you do? If you marked any of the scenarios as true, think again! All of the above scenarios are false because they broke some aspect of telephone etiquette. Therefor the customer would get a negative impression of the company.

ACTIVITY 2

Answering a call

1. Based on your experience of when you have phoned different companies, why is it important to have an answering standard when you answer the phone?

2. Set up your own answering standard for **your** company. What will be included in the standard?

3. Use **your own company name** and write the direct words that will be used when a telephone is answered in your company.

ACTIVITY 3

Putting a customer on hold

In scenario two, Sipho did not ask the customer if he could put him on hold – he told him. This can be very frustrating for a customer. Furthermore, Sipho did not ask permission to take the call in the first place. The person standing in front of you is as important as the person on the telephone. Acknowledge this with a gesture or “May I answer quickly?” before reaching for the phone.

The etiquette for putting your customers on hold will help you avoid becoming confused and thereby avoid the many negative moments of truth that the customer associates with the telephone.

Think of a particular scenario that you / your parents were involved in and then discuss the following questions:

1. How did you feel when someone put you on hold for a long time?

2. What did the person say before he/she put you on hold?



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3. What was your impression of the customer service?

4. Did the person say anything that made you as a customer, feel special?
What did he say?

5. Why do people dislike being put on hold?

6. How should you approach the caller before putting him on hold?

7. What is wrong with putting your hand over the receiver?

8. Why should you explain to a customer why he is being transferred?

ACTIVITY 4

How to transfer a call

In your groups, discuss the following:

1. Why should you explain to the customer why he is being transferred?

2. Why should you give the customer the person's name and telephone number before you transfer his call?

3. Are you allowed to give employers' personal information to customers?

ACTIVITY 5

Taking a message

Study the following two messages and then answer the question.

	MESSAGE 1			MESSAGE 2
To	Khumalo		To	Khosi Matshitse
Date	18 th		Date	15 March 2004
From	Sarel		From	Ronel Jacobs
Company			Company	BP Personnel
Tel no	You have it		Tel no	011 555 4512
Message			Message	Ronel needs the detail on case 26 urgently.
Taken by	Maria		Taken by	Maria Matsana

1. Which message is the better one? _____ (1)

2. Motivate your answer. (7)

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

3. Use the scenario that follows to complete the message slip.

Mr. Combe, the principal of Kings High, phoned at 11:25 to talk to the principal of Queens High, Mrs Kastanos. He wants to discuss the program for the athletic meeting taking place during the weekend. Mrs. Kastanos is busy with a meeting and can't take the phone call. Mr. Combe asked to be phoned back after the meeting on his cell phone - 084 6622 315

MESSAGE	
	
To: _____	Date: _____ Time: _____
From: _____	Company: _____
Tel. no. _____	
Message: _____ _____	
Taken by: _____	

TOTAL 20

ACTIVITY 6

Skills practice

Practice the following three skills with a friend. Give informative feedback to the person practising the skill so that he can better himself.

Quality check according to:	FEEDBACK
Answering a telephone. Ensure they used the agreed procedure • Pick up the phone within 3 rings • Greet the caller • Give your company / department name as well as your own • Ask the customer how you can help.	
Putting a caller on hold. Ensure they used the agreed procedure • Did he ask the caller permission to be put on hold and to be transferred? • Did he give the caller the name and number of the person to whom they are being transferred? • Did he tell the person being called who was on the line and why?	
Taking a message for another person. Ensure they used the agreed procedure • Did he take all the caller's relevant details? • Did he summarise the message correctly? • Did he check for accuracy e.g. repeating the telephone number?	

ANNEXURE 5: Year 3 Term 4

READING

1. What is reading but silent conversation? (Walter Savage Landor)

Reading applies to written text (paper) and visual media. In the workplace, most people would be surprised if they ever physically timed themselves, to discover that they spend a lot of time reading: memos, e-mail, internet research, letters, reports, advertising, articles, textbooks, computers and cell phones.

2. Why is reading so important?

With the huge amount of written material (in books, magazines, internet, emails, reports etc.) the old saying, “**Don’t believe everything you read**”, has never been truer!

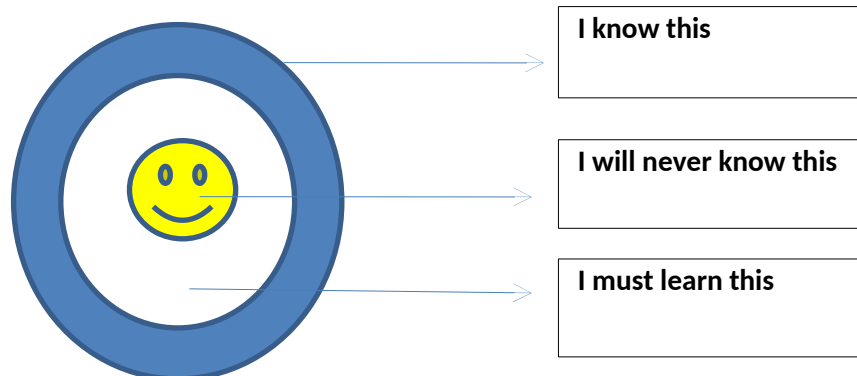
The **world of work is an ever-changing**, increasingly demanding environment. What was the ‘latest and greatest’ last year is now old news. While this is exciting, it is also very pressurising.

We have to **stay abreast of changes** and we have **to constantly improve our knowledge and skills to remain employable**. Reading is inseparable from lifelong learning.

The usual complaint about time is that there just aren’t enough hours in the day. There are, however, two possible solutions to this problem: we can learn to read faster and/or become a more selective reader

3. The 3 circles are a useful tool for selective reading:

The circle represents the sum total of all the knowledge in the world.



You can make the outer circle a lot bigger by reading newspapers, searching the Internet, reading on new topics and watching television.

4. Motivational phrases to read every day?

Write it on colourful paper and put it up all over your room:

- Knowledge belongs to everyone.
- It is completely within my power to increase my knowledge.
- Knowledge is not static – it is always increasing.
- Knowledge is truly power.
- Reading is one of the main routes to better knowledge.
- Self-improvement depends on increasing our knowledge.

Do activity 1: Reading

5. Reading methods

5.1 Speed reading

Remember when you first learned how to read as a child? It was a painfully slow process: The – cat – sat – on – the – mat... That was because your brain had to process each word individually. As you recognised words, you speeded up.

Just see how amazing your brain works! Read this:

**I cdnuolt blveiee taht I cluod aulacly uesdnatnrd waht I was
rdanieg The phaonmneal pweor of the hmuan mnid Aoccdrnig to
a rscheearch at Cmabrigde Uinervtisy, it deosn't mtt aer inwaht
oredr the ltteers in a wrod are, the olny iprmoatnt tihng is taht
the frist and lsat ltteer be in the rghit pclae. The rset can be a
taotl mses and you can sitll raed it wouthit a porbelm. Tihs is
bcuseae the huamn mnid deos not raed ervey lteter by istlef, but
the wrod as a wlohe. Amzanig huh? yaeh and I awlyas thought
slpeling was ipmorantt!**

Test yourself by timing how long you take to read the following passage of just over two hundred words. Read silently, to yourself. You must read to comprehend.

Do activity 2: Speed Reading.

5.2 Skimming and Scanning

- Quickly read through text to save time when you search for information.
- Intentionally skip parts of the text.
- Only pay attention to specific information.
- Focus on headings, sub headings, italic or bold words, words and pictures standing out.
- Use it to find specific information like numbers, amounts, dates, names etc.
- Where do you use it? Look up telephone numbers in a telephone directory, words in a dictionary, studying a weather chart or a bus schedule, searching websites etc.

Do activity 3 on Skimming and Scanning

5.3 Study reading

- Slowest kind of reading.
- Read carefully leaving nothing out.
- Read with attention.
- Think about what you read.
- Stop frequently to check if you remember and understand.
- Try to memorise what you have read.
- KEYWORDS: the most important words in a sentence or paragraph are highlighted. It enables you to understand a sentence and focus on the essence of the sentence.

Do activity 4 on Study Reading

Information

Literacy

You will need information literacy skills throughout your life. We are always seeking information. What is the best car to buy? Which courses should I study? Which is the best book to read on a particular subject? How will I convince my boss that this is a good idea? How to learn to do something new?

Information helps us to make the best decisions! It also helps us to communicate more effectively, because we are speaking with confidence, based on facts. However, the good stuff is often buried beneath heaps of rubbish.

The skill of searching, sifting, evaluating and comprehending written and visual literacy, is therefore vital to our effectiveness in the world of work.

1. How do I choose the correct media to search for information?

I must know what kind of information I want to know where to start searching for it.
Some examples:

<u>What information do I need?</u> ©	<u>Media that is used</u>
To sell a product	
To give information	
To persuade	
To manipulate	
To entertain	
To scare	
To educate	

Do activity 5: Information Literacy

2. Posters

Posters can be a very effective form of communication. You may have learnt in History about or seen in movies the posters used by different nations during war or times of political change. They all had read: "Your country needs you". It was very persuasive because it addressed the emotions and patriotism of the men.

Posters are seen on lamp posts, on information boards inside/outside shops, at schools, concerts etc. Posters are usually big enough so that a driver can read it when driving past it. Some posters have photos to draw the attention of the reader.

What are the characteristics that make a poster an effective tool of communication?

- A poster should be **eye-catching**.
- Give the **minimum, but vital information** in as **few words as possible**.
- The information **must stand out**. Use **letter types** that are **big** and **clear** and that can be **read at a glance from a distance**.
- Use **bright colours** to **attract attention**.
- The poster must be **uncluttered**.

Do activity 6: Design a poster

3. Critical eye

A critical eye, or the ability to evaluate what you are reading for bias, authenticity and reliability, is an important skill when reading – especially if you are doing research. Writers have many purposes in mind when they write – to sell, to persuade, to inform etc.

In evaluating a persuasive text (selling an idea or concept) the critical reader should be able to classify the information given according to the following hierarchy of reliability:

1. **Facts** – verified either by experience or reference to authoritative records
2. **Conclusions** – derived from facts by reasoning about it
3. **Judgements** – derived by reflection on the material given (the professional competence of the person judging weighs heavily here)
4. **Opinions** – need careful evaluation, even if they ring true
5. **Beliefs** – views that have no factual backing. Often underpin our thoughts and are 'unstated', but evident if you are on the look out for bias

Do activity 7: Critical Eye

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

Activity 1: Reading

1. Why is reading so important? (5)

2. Explain the 3 circles of reading priorities? (3)

3. Explain how you can make the outer circle bigger? (3)

4. What will you do to motivate yourself to expand your reading? (4)

5. What would you like to learn more of? (5)

TOTAL 20

Activity 2 Speed Reading

The teacher is going to be the timekeeper. The teacher will tell you when to start reading and when to stop. It is going to be exactly 60 seconds. Read the passage in the notes silently to yourself.

Make a mark on the text where you stopped reading. Count the words.

Repeat above steps 3 times.

1st _____ words per minute

2nd _____ words per minute

3rd _____ words per minute

1. What conclusion do you come to after you did the exercise three times?

2. By doing this exercise twice a day at home, what could you expect after a week?

3. What can you do to motivate yourself to read more?

Activity 3 Skimming and Scanning

Skim the article: "Snapshot of SA Cyberspace" and answer the questions.

1. What is the title of the article? _____
2. Who is the author? _____2
3. In which magazine did the article appear? _____
4. On what date did it appear? _____3
5. What city has the biggest Facebook population in S.A. ?

6. Which city has 840 000 Facebook users? _____
7. What is the average number of photos uploaded everyday worldwide? _____
8. How old is the biggest percentage of users? _____2
9. Are the most Facebook users male or female? _____
10. How many Facebook users are there in S.A.? _____2

TOTAL 15

YOU CONSUMER

SNAPSHOT OF SA CYBERSPACE

From social networking to search terms, a recent survey yields fascinating facts and figures on how South Africans use the internet

By PETRO-ANNE VLOK

WITH the internet you have the world at your fingertips. You can catch up with friends via Facebook, follow your favourite celebrities on Twitter or read up on the day's news.

What you search for online depends on what you want – but have you ever wondered how the rest of the country spends their time online? iProspect, a digital marketing agency, recently released its findings on what South Africans get up to in cyberspace in 2011.



FACEBOOK

Facebook has reached just 8,7 per cent of the South African population yet it's used by 80,7 per cent of internet users in South Africa.

With two million users, Johannesburg has the biggest Facebook population. Next is Cape Town with 860 000, followed by Pretoria with 840 000 users.

250m

The average number of photos uploaded to Facebook every day worldwide. That's about 7,5 billion photos each month, 10,4 million photos an hour and about 174 000 a minute.

4 840 360

The number of Facebook users in South Africa. About 480 000 new users signed up during the last six months of 2011.

AGE-SPLIT

33%

of users are between 18 and 24 years old

14%

are between 35 and 44

31%

of users are between 25 and 34 years old

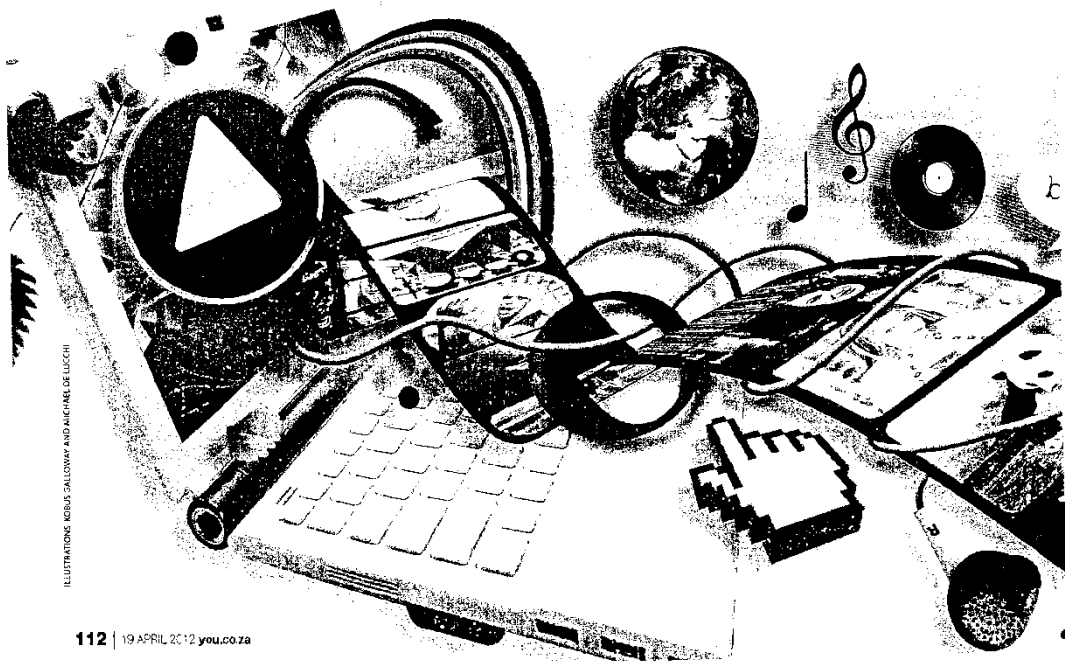
22%

are 45 and older

GENDER

49% are male users 51% are female

F 20 minutes – The average time South Africans spend on Facebook every day.



Activity 4
Study Reading

Apply Study Reading on the article: "Balls, glorious balls" and answer the questions.

1. What is the heading? _____
2. What is the sub heading? _____
_____ 4
3. Who made the first rugby ball? _____
_____ 2
4. What was the ball made of? _____ 2
5. How did they inflate the balls? _____ 2
6. What are rugby balls made of today? _____
_____ 5
7. How many stitches are there on a cricket ball? _____ 2
8. What is used to stuff cricket balls and what do they weigh?
_____ 2
9. Where and when was the most expensive cricket ball ever made? _____ 2
10. Give three reasons why it is the most expensive cricket ball.

_____ 3

Total 25

HEY!
YOU!

BALLS, GLORIOUS BALLS

By CHRIZANE VAN ZYL

RUGBY

Did you know rugby players used to play with balls made from pigs' bladders? In 1849 Richard Lindon and William Gilbert made the first rugby balls from the bladders of swine.



This explains why the ball is oval. Players inflated the bladders with clay straws – quite an unpleasant job as the bladders were smelly. Yuck!

The bladders were covered with leather panels and stitched by hand. The first balls had four panels joined together and their size depended on the size of the bladder used.

Today rugby balls still have four panels but are made from synthetic rubber, polyurethane layers, microfibre and PVC. What an exact science the manufacturing of balls has become!

Balls are still sometimes made from leather as they give a better grip. But players practise mostly with synthetic balls which are waterproof and last longer.

CRICKET

The first cricket balls were made around 1560 and like the tennis balls of old were covered with leather. There are between 65 and 70 stitches on a cricket ball; it's mostly stuffed with cork and weighs about 163 g. The cork is elastic and helps the ball to bounce. The ball consists of small pieces of cork rolled up with pieces of string and



tied together. The most expensive cricket ball ever was made in

Sri Lanka in 2004 – of diamonds! It weighed 53,83 carats and the various panels were joined with a real gold seam. But how were the diamonds joined? With the same material used in Nasa space vehicles.

Cricket bats are made of willow wood. The wood is first compressed by putting weights of up to three tons on top of them. That's the equivalent of 12 elephants!

SOCCER

Charles Goodyear made the first rubber soccer balls in 1855. Before that anything from a skull to a stuffed sphere was used to play soccer. Because leather was expensive the balls were also made from pigs' bladders.

The Chinese were among the first to play soccer. They kicked the balls through a gap in a net stretched between two poles.

It's also believed the English played soccer in the Middle Ages. They kicked the skulls of people who'd been beheaded down the street – gruesome!



Today a soccer ball is made of 32 leather panels sewn together with 720 stitches. The panels are made from synthetic leather reinforced with layers of cotton or polyester.

Pakistan is renowned for its soccer balls which are sewn by hand. Nearly 90 per cent of soccer balls are made there. Latex bladders are used today and balls weigh 320-540 g.

GOLF

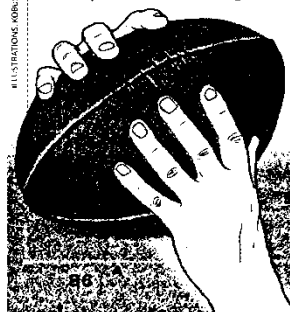
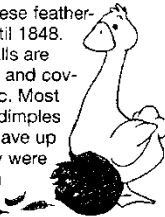
Golf was invented by the ancient Romans who played it with wooden clubs. Until the 16th century golfers had to make their own clubs and used wood for this purpose. It was only in the 18th century that golf clubs were first made of iron.

The first golf balls were made of thin leather and stuffed with boiled duck feathers. The tighter the feathers were packed the further the balls travelled. Golfers used these feather-stuffed balls until 1848.

Today golf balls are made of rubber and covered with plastic. Most balls have 336 dimples but some can have up to 420. But why were balls made with dimples?

The first (smooth) balls were soon covered in scratches and dents and players discovered the more damaged the ball the further it travelled. The balls were then made with identical dimples so they would fly equally well.

You'd need a chainsaw to cut through the plastic and rubber of a golf ball. Inside are tightly rolled-up rubber bands.



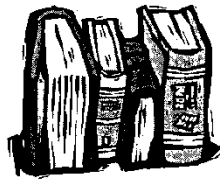
BALLS BACK IN THE OLD DAYS

ACTIVITY 5
Information Literacy

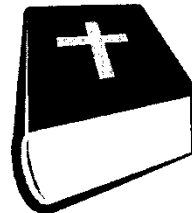
Study the following examples and say which media can be used to do each of the following.



Scary picture



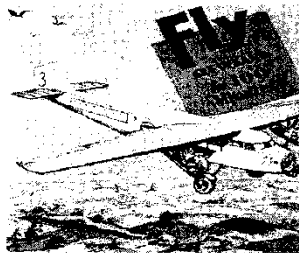
Text book



Bible



Cartoon



Flyer



Interdict
I hereby certify that Remo Smith are not supposed to be near Roseline Evert by doing so he will be taken into custody.



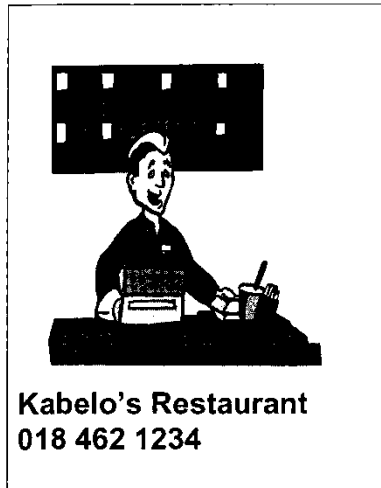
Thabo
I will wait for you at the gate after school. I will get you because you school my cold drink during break.
Be warned.
Thabang

Letter to scare someone

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)

TERM 3

Poster



Advertisement

Win 1 of 20 Busby Oils' Liquid Gold hampers worth R200 each.

Try Busby Oils' Liquid Gold Pure Tissue Oil, a clinically proven natural alternative for beautiful skin. Our Liquid Gold Pure Tissue Oil is clinically proven to improve the appearance of scars, stretch marks, wrinkles, ageing and dehydrated skin. Consisting mainly of natural oils, and rich in vitamin E, this product is suitable for use during pregnancy and on sensitive skin. For more information and to see our whole product range, visit us on www.facebook.com/busbyliquidgold, visit our website at www.busbyoils.co.za or phone 033 343 1767.

To stand a chance of winning 1 of 20 Busby Liquid Gold Hampers worth R200 each, simply send your details to info@busbyoils.co.za with "YOU Competition" in the subject line or phone 033 343 1767 before midnight on 17 May 2012.



YOU cannot vouch for the efficacy or safety of any products advertised on this page. Advertisers are responsible for delivery. Normal cellphone rates apply.

Information – Facts

What are the symptoms of undiagnosed or uncontrolled diabetes?

- Urinating often, especially at night
- Constant intense thirst
- Losing weight without trying
- Tired and hungry all the time
- Blurred vision
- Tingling in the feet
- Sores that heal slowly
- Dry, itchy skin

Did you know?
Up to 85% of South Africans may not experience any symptoms and thus remain undiagnosed

So, if most people do not experience symptoms, how do I know if I am at risk for diabetes?

Your risk increases if you:

- Are **over 40**
- **Overweight** and inactive
- **Black or Indian**
- Have a **family member** with diabetes
- Have **high** blood pressure (over 140/90 mmHg)
- Have **high "bad" fat (cholesterol) levels** and low "good" fat (HDL) levels
- **Developed diabetes during pregnancy** or have had a large baby (more than 4 kg)

Joke

SHRINKING WORLD

Trying to explain to his five-year-old daughter how much computers have changed, a man points to the family's new PC and tells her when he was at university a computer that powerful would have been the size of a house.

Wide-eyed, the little girl asks, "How big was the mouse?"

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)

TERM 3



Samsung Galaxy TAB 7.0 Plus (P6200)

R239

op MTN AnyTime 100

Sluit in	R100	Lugtdwaarde (BTW, ingesl.) pmx24
	25 SMS's	pmx24

Kenmerke: Android Honeycomb, Sakgrootte,
1.2GHz Dual Core Verwerker, HSDPA 21Mbps

+ Gratis aflewering, SIM en Aansluiting.

Advertisement cell phone

MERCEDES-BENZ C180 BLUEEFFICIENCY (AUTOMATIC)



The Mercedes-Benz C Class Estate is our first choice and a good buy in every respect. Of course the Mercedes badge is attractive but the C Class models' real plusses are its build quality and luxurious interior which can be enhanced with various comfort features.

Mercedes injected new life into the C Class in 2011 with a fresh appearance and scores of technical improvements. This model's 1.8-litre engine has more than enough punch while also providing a great ride. And of course the generous loading space is the cherry on top.

PRICE

R383 000

LOAD AREA

485-1 500 litres

ENGINE AND PERFORMANCE

1.8-litre four-cylinder turbo petrol;
115 kW; 230 Nm; 0-100 km/h in 9,9 sec;
top speed 215 km/h

FUEL CONSUMPTION

6,7 l/100 km

MONTHLY INSTALMENT

R7 674 (12 per cent interest, 60 months,
10 per cent deposit)

VERDICT

★★★★★

HONDA ACCORD TOURER 2,4 EXECUTIVE (MANUAL)



The Honda Accord's price tag might put you off a bit but, unlike its competitors, it has a high level of standard equipment.

It's a typical Honda, which means it will probably give you years of good service with little chance of problems cropping up. Hondas are generally enjoyable cars to drive and this station wagon doesn't disappoint in that department either.

The engine is powerful and the Accord can easily tow a caravan or trailer. Unfortunately its load area is a little cramped compared with its competitors.

PRICE

R390 400

LOAD AREA

272-1 064 litres

ENGINE AND PERFORMANCE

2.4-litre four-cylinder petrol; 148 kW;
234 Nm; 0-100 km/h in 8,5 sec;
top speed 222 km/h

FUEL CONSUMPTION

8,9 l/100 km

MONTHLY INSTALMENT

R7 815 (12 per cent interest, 60 month,
10 per cent deposit)

VERDICT

★★★★★

Statistics

ACTIVITY 6

Poster

Choose one of the following:

1. Design a poster that demonstrates the dangers of pollution.
2. Design a poster that illustrates your culture.
3. Design a poster to advertise your own business.

Marks will be given for:

- Catch the eye (10)
- Minimum information (10)
- Words standing out (10)
- Letters bright and clear (10)
- Pictures and colours (10)

TOTAL 50

ACTIVITY 7
Critical eye

Give an example at each of the following:

- Fact

- Inferences

- Judgements

- Opinions

- Believes

Study the following examples and only write down the correct number at each example.

Word	Number	Example
Fact		1. Mr Lombard is absent today because he is ill.
Inferences		2. I think you are a nice guy.
Judgements		3. There are seven days in a week.
Opinion		4. You are guilty because you were in Game when the iPad was stolen.
Believes		5. You are a thief.

TOTAL 10

SUMMARY

12 Ways Your Phone Is Changing You by Tony Reinke is a thoughtful exploration into how our smartphone technology can—and most likely already has—influenced how we live our lives. Beyond the obvious convenience smartphones bring into our lives, these portals to social media platforms, virtual communities, near-instant service, and continuous streams of information produce non-obvious changes that alter the ways we interact with each other and with God.

Do You Control Your Phone — Or Does Your Phone Control You?

Within a few years of its unveiling, the smartphone had become part of us, fully integrated into the daily patterns of our lives. Never offline, always within reach, we now wield in our hands a magic wand of technological power we have only begun to grasp. But it raises new enigmas, too. Never more connected, we seem to be growing more distant. Never more efficient, we have never been more distracted.

4. Fear of Missing Out

Do you know what nomophobia is? No-mobile-phone phobia. FOMO (fear of missing out) hits us on two sides: anxiety that we're not staying updated on information if we're not checking our phone, and insecurity of not getting the affirmation we want if we're offline.

A need to use the cell phone more and more often.

- **Preoccupation** with smart phone use.

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

- Turns to cell phone when experiencing unwanted feelings such as anxiety or depression.
- **Excessive use** characterized by loss of sense of time.
- Has put a **relationship or job at risk** due to excessive cell phone use.

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

Tolerance Need for newest cell phone, more applications, or increased use.

- **Withdrawal**, when cell phone or network is unreachable.
 - Anger.
 - Tension.
 - Depression.
 - Irritability.
 - Restlessness.

If you or a loved one displays these signs and symptoms of cell phone addiction, help is readily available. Call the phone number above to speak with a treatment specialist about various recovery options.

- **Car accidents.**

- Many people believe that they can multitask and use their phones while driving, but this causes significant impairment and puts the driver and others on the road in danger.
- Research has revealed that **texting and driving can be just as dangerous as drinking and driving.**⁷
- Seeing teens standing together, but totally ignoring each other is a common sight these days. According to a survey conducted by the Pew Research Center, 78% teens aged between 12 and 17 have mobile phones. And they are not just using it to call their parents. One in four teens have access to the internet, far more than adults. So is cell phone really a good thing for teens? What are the negative effects of cell phones on teenagers? Read on to find the answer.

- **Effects Of Mobile Phones On Teenagers:**

- There is no doubt that the mobile phone is a very useful tool and today, mobile phones are a major part of society. . It eases communication with colleagues, friends and relatives. But every technology that provides such benefits comes with a consequent price. The impact of mobile phones on youth and society is astronomical. It is this area that requires attention, when you are giving your teen a cell phone. Here's how cell phones affect teenagers.

- **1.Teen Tendonitis (TTT):**

- What is the impact of mobile phones on young people's social life? Teenagers are totally addicted to texting. Excess messaging can lead to Teen Tendonitis (TTT). It can cause pain in the hands, back and neck due to poor posture. It can also lead to impaired vision and even arthritis down the line.

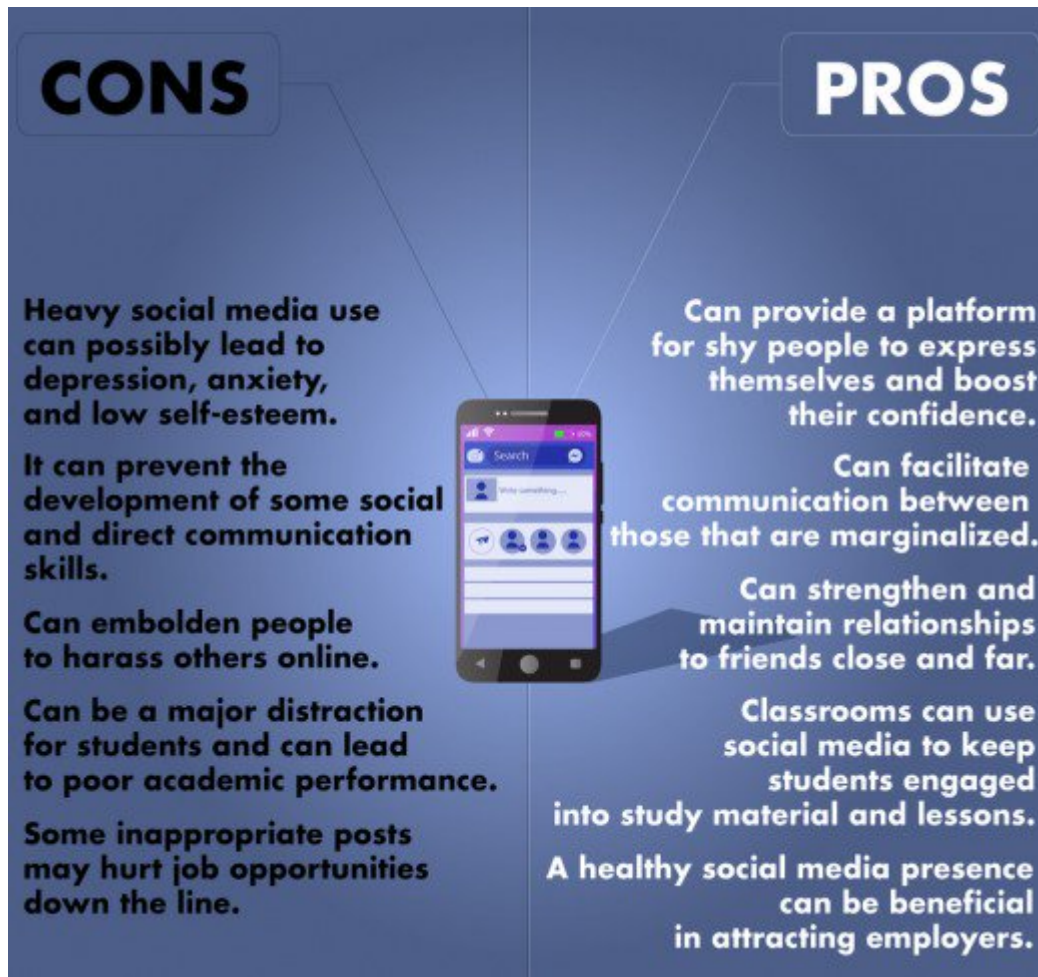
The Advantages of Texting



Image
from: <http://gettingsmart.com/cms/blog/2011/11/the-power-of-texting-a-changing-communication-medium-in-changing-times/>

Positives that can come from text messaging or other instant messaging technology are:

- Able to contact people easier
- Can call someone (or text) for help
- Some phones have apps that can help with daily things (GPS, yellowpages, etc)
- And more to help people



DEBATE Should Kids Have Cell Phones in School?

For many kids, the ringing of a cell phone is as familiar as the sound of a school bell. Inexpensive service plans, parental concerns about their safety, and the fact that most kids are social creatures have helped to make cell phones a part of their everyday life.

Nonetheless, many school districts **prohibit** (ban) students from carrying and using cell phones in classrooms and hallways. School board members say that cell phones distract students from learning and can be used as a tool for cheating.

Not everyone thinks this is fair.



and students to communicate—especially in an emergency. With-

**What do you think?
Should kids have cell**

YES

You can't schedule for surprises. School violence, terrorist attacks, and medical emergencies can happen at any time.

Having a cell phone in such situations may help relieve anxieties or even save lives.

Kids can learn how to use a cell phone at appropriate times, like during recess or between classes. Banning cell phones won't teach kids how to use them responsibly.

"Cell phones are important to have when a parent gets stuck in traffic or when a student misses the bus home," says Eric Perry, 14, of New York City. "Not everyone uses cell phones to cheat or take embarrassing pictures of people."

NO

Ringling phones disrupt lessons and exams. Would-be cheaters can transmit information through text messages and camera phones. Such phones can also invade other people's privacy and lead to embarrassing photos.

Parents and children do have a need to communicate. But such communication can take place through the school secretary or administrator.

"All schools have telephones in the classroom or main office," says Sharan Gwynn, a social studies teacher in Georgetown, Kentucky. "Children are allowed access to those phones as long as they are not distracting the class. Everyday details and emergencies can be handled through the school."

VOTE NOW! Should kids have cell phones in school?

Vote online at www.scholastic.com/juniorscholastic

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

Rubric to assess a discussion

Listening and speaking 30 marks	Level 4	Level 3	Level 2	Level 1
	8-10	6-7	4-5	1-3
Participation in debate	Skilfully sustains a conversation; listens to others with respect; takes turns; justifies own point of view; shows excellent understanding of the topic	Takes part in the discussion; listens to others with respect; takes a point of view and sometimes justifies it; takes turns; shows understanding of the topic	Takes part in the discussion adequately; able to listen and follow; few interruptions of others; defends viewpoint adequately; shows some understanding of the topic	Takes little or no part in the discussion; does not listen to others; or frequently interrupts; does not follow the thread of the debat; does not take a viewpoint
Ability to express self orally	Expresses her/himself very well. Able to say what he/she wants to say clearly and easily with few or no mistakes.	Expresses him/herself well. Able to say what he/she wants to say clearly and fairly easily, but with some mistakes.	Expresses him/herself with some difficulty. Struggles to say what he/she wants to say and makes many mistakes.	Struggles to express him/herself orally. Makes many mistakes. Difficult to understand. Says only one or two words.
Voice projection and modulation	Excellent	Very good	Poor	Hampers communication
TOTAL	30			

Activity 3: READING & VIEWING

Participate in shared / paired / individual reading.

CONTENT

- Pronounce words correctly.
- Recognise new vocabulary.
- Take part in shared reading.
- Read in pairs.
- Read out loud for marks.

Read the following extract out loud.

He ran downstairs to warn our first-floor neighbours, leaving our front door open. I could smell smoke. The sirens had **multiplied** — three fire trucks outside, maybe four. I turned to the back, where my now 6-year-old son was fast asleep in his bedroom off the kitchen. There were 20 steps between him and me.

“I’ll get him!” I shouted to my husband.

“Great,” he said, already moving. “I’ll grab some stuff and meet you in the car.”

Rating scale: Reading aloud (unprepared) – 25 marks

Description	Marks	Learner's Marks
Reads a suitable text aloud with good expression, tone, volume and pace; projects voice; reads fluently and pronounces words correctly; answers questions about what is read correctly	8-10	
Reads a suitable text aloud, with some mistakes in pronunciation; makes use of tone, volume and pace; lots of pauses and tends to stop before every word (not fluent); answers some questions about what is read correctly	4-7	
Many mistakes in pronunciation; makes little or no use of tone, volume and pace; learner is almost unable to decode (sound out) words correctly; very little or no understanding of what is read	0-3	
TOTAL	10÷10x25	

DATE: _____

TOPIC: ON FIRE!

Activity 4: WRITING AND PRESENTING

CONTENT

- Build vocabulary
- Copy the format of a friendly letter.
- Write a letter to your friend.

4.1 Let's look at a friendly letter

1. HEADING	Your personal address	12 Ruby Street
	The date	Geduld Springs 1506 17 July 2018
2. GREETING		Dear Lerato
3.1 INTRODUCTION		Have you ever thought about what would happen if your house caught fire? What would you save first?
3. CONTENT		Last night my brother played with the paraffin stove and accidentally set our house on fire. I was terrified.
CONCLUSION		First I grabbed my little brother and carried him outside. Next I asked the neighbours to phone the fire brigade. After that we waited for my parents to come home.

Note: The original image includes 'SKIP A LINE' instructions between sections and arrows indicating the flow of the letter structure.

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

	SKIP A LINE
	Most of our possessions were lost in the fire. I saved my brother first because he meant more to me than objects. This experience taught me that quick thinking can save lives.
	SKIP A LINE
	Hope to see you soon.
4. FINAL GREETING	→ Your friend
	SKIP A LINE
5. YOUR NAME	→ Nomsa

4.2 Copy the format of an informal letter

1) H.....	→	Your personal	}	
	→	The	}	
2) G.....	→	Dear ...		
		SKIP A LINE		
3) C.....	→	SKIP A LINE		
↓		.		
3.1) I.....	→	SKIP A LINE		
↓		SKIP A LINE		
3.2) B.....	→	SKIP A LINE		
↓		SKIP A LINE		
3.3) C.....	→	SKIP A LINE		
		Your friend		
4) F.....	→	SKIP A LINE		
5) Y.....	→			

4.3 Write a letter to your friend. Tell your friend what happened the day your house caught fire. Use the correct format (informal letter).

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)

TERM 3

Rating scale to assess a letter: Self and peer assessment			
	Very good	Good	Needs work
The letter has an introduction, a body and a conclusion			
The letter has the address and date in the correct places			
Letter has a suitable greeting and final greeting			
Letter uses suitable language (informal)			

[illegible]

DATE: _____

TOPIC: ON FIRE!

Activity 5: PREPARED READING

CONTENT

- Read out loud.

Dear Lerato

Have you ever thought about what would happen if your house caught fire? What would you save first?

Last night my brother played with the paraffin stove and accidently set our house on fire. I was terrified.

First I grabbed my little brother and carried him outside. Next I asked the neighbours to phone the fire brigade. After that we waited for my parents to come home.

Most of our possessions were lost in the fire. I saved my brother first because he meant more to me than objects. This experience taught me that quick thinking can save lives.

Hope to see you soon.

Best wishes

Nomsa



INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

Rubric to assess prepared reading

Criteria	LEVEL 7	LEVEL 6	LEVEL 5	LEVEL 4	LEVEL 3	LEVEL 2	LEVEL 1
MARKS	10 – 8	7	6	5	4	3	2 – 0
25							
Demonstrates use of tone and inflection	Reads expressively and creates atmosphere. Conveys feelings exceptionally well	Reads with very good expression and attempts made to convey feelings or atmosphere	Reads with good expression and attempts made to convey feelings or atmosphere	Makes an attempt to read with expression	Reads, but with limited expression	Meaning can be followed but not expression	Too poor to be expressive. Meaning lost
Use of voice and mastery of reading skills	Fluent, very entertaining reading Excellent voice projection and diction which enhances meaning	Fluent reading Very good voice projection and diction which enhances meaning	Reading fluency in a monotone Good voice projection and diction which enhances meaning	Reads reasonably fluently Reading is clear and audible and diction enhances meaning	Reads with limited fluency Reading is audible and pronunciation does not affect meaning	Reading not fluent Reading not always audible and many words are mispronounced	Halted reading Poor pronunciation and poor delivery make the delivery almost incomprehensible
Use of eye / audience contact	Altogether appropriate eye-contact	Very good eye-contact	Good eye-contact	Successful efforts to make eye-contact	Eye-contact adequate	Unsuccessful attempts at making eye-contact	Almost no eye-contact
Responses to questions shows critical interpretation of the text	Handles questions with total confidence, ease and sensitivity to the text	Handles questions with confidence, ease and sensitivity to the text	Handles questions and responds sensibly with minor lapses	Handles questions and responds sensibly with lapses	Understand questions and can answer some of the questions	Understands questions and provides flawed answers	Is mostly unable to understand or respond to questions
Prepared and confident	Reading is exceptionally well prepared and confident	Reader well prepared and reads with confidence	Reader prepared and reads with confidence	Reader is adequately familiar with the text – has made an effort to prepare	Limited amount of preparation. Reads with moderate confidence	Reader has not prepared the text. Obviously nervous	No evidence of preparation. Very nervous and demonstrates a lack of commitment
TOTALS	50÷2=25						



DATE: _____

TOPIC: ON FIRE!

Activity 6: LANGUAGE STRUCTURES & CONVENTIONS

CONTENT

- Introduce common nouns.
- Underline common nouns in a text.
- Use common nouns in a sentence

Refresher!

Nouns are words that name people, places, things or ideas.

Proper nouns name **specific** people, places, things or ideas

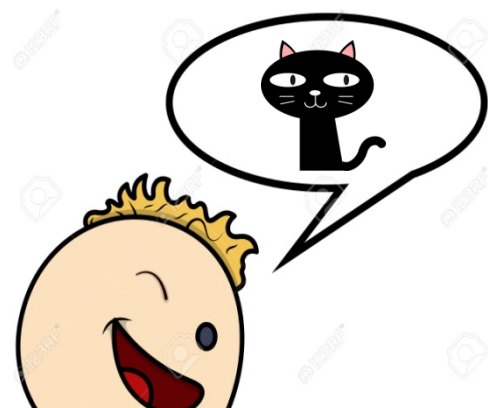
Lerato, Springs, Woolworths

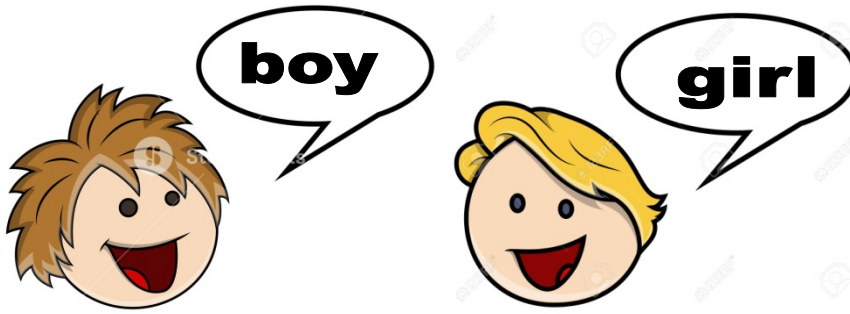
Since these nouns are naming specific things, they always begin with a capital letter.

Let's look at common nouns.

Common nouns name people, places, things or ideas that are **not specific** like woman, city, dog, shoe.

Since these nouns aren't naming anything specific, they don't need to start with a capital letter unless they begin a sentence.



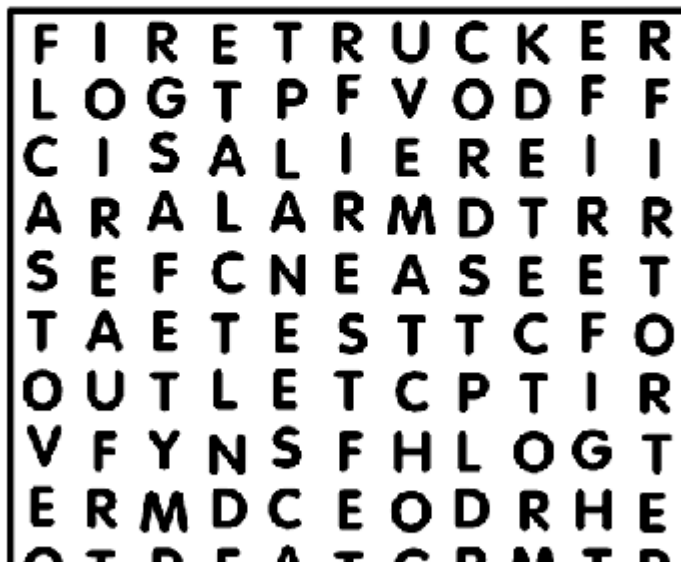


6.1 Circle the **common nouns** that you find in the word search.

Read the following sentences to determine if the words are common nouns.

1. The smoke DETECTOR set off the ALARM .
 2. I ESCAPE through the window.
 3. My brother found a MATCH lying around.
 4. We had a PLAN.
 5. The LOG caught fire.
 6. When you are caught in a FIRE: STOP, DROP and ROLL.
 7. Use a MAP to find your way and crawl to SAFETY.
 8. First TEST if the door is too hot to handle by holding your hand near it.
 9. The FIRETRUCK stopped in front and a FIREFIGHTER ran through the SMOKE.
- Cross out the words in the list that are not common nouns before you start.
 - Cross out the list words as you find them.

ALARM ESCAPE MATCH PLAN LOG STOP
SAFETY DETECTOR TEST MAP ROLL FIRE
DROP FIREFIGHTER SMOKE FIRETRUCK



6.2 Underline the common nouns in the following text.

On the way to my son's room, I stopped to put on pants; I put a toothbrush in one pocket and moisturizer in the other. Then I ran into the bedroom and grabbed the hunting knife from my bedside table.

6.3 Fill in a common noun for every proper noun.

Choose the correct words from the box.

dog girl boy truck store river restaurant town

PROPER NOUN Name specific people, places, things, ideas	COMMON NOUN Name people, places, things, ideas that are NOT specific
Example: Capitec	bank
Ben	
Checkers	
Susan	
Springs	

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

Ford	
Nile	
Pit-bull	
Spur	

6.4 Use common nouns in proper structured sentences.

Complete the sentence by filling in a common noun.

determine r	common noun	verb	adverb
The		spread	quickly.

pronoun	verb	preposition	determiner	common noun	adverb
She	ran	to	the		immediately.

proper noun	verb	determiner	common noun
Nomsa	called	the	

pronoun	verb	conjunction	verb	determiner	common noun
----------------	-------------	--------------------	-------------	-------------------	--------------------

They	arrived	and	saved	the	
------	---------	-----	-------	-----	--

pronoun	verb	preposition	determiner	common noun
He	crawls	through	the	

DATE: _____ **TOPIC (2): OUT OF THIS WORLD**

Activity 7: LISTENING & SPEAKING

Let's look at a poem

CONTENT

- Follow pointer during shared reading
- Take part in short discussion on a poem
- Rap a poem in groups and act it out



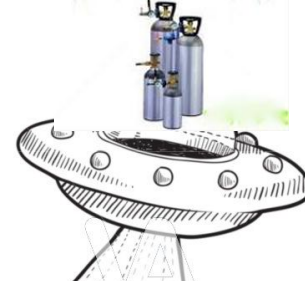
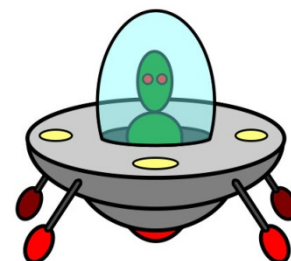
7.1 Colour the picture.





THERE'S AN ALIEN IN MY BEDROOM

A simple line drawing of a grey alien. It has a large, oval head with two prominent, black, almond-shaped eyes. The face is covered in fine, vertical lines. The body is small and rounded, with two long, thin arms extending outwards. Each arm has three small, oval fingers. The alien is standing on a flat surface, with a dark, irregular shadow cast beneath it. The drawing is done in a minimalist, sketchy style.



7.3 Discuss the poem.

7.4 Divide into groups and rap the poem.

DATE: _____

TOPIC: OUT OF THIS WORLD

Activity 8: READING AND VIEWING

CONTENT

- Group read the poem and sing it to a rap sound while acting it out.

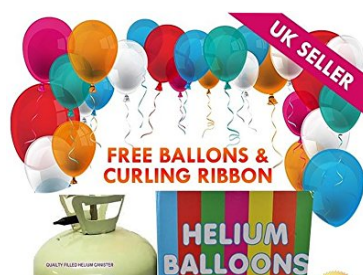
8.1 Divide into groups.

8.2 Read the poem “There’s an alien in my bedroom” on page 23.

8.3 Plan how to rap and act it out.

Rubric for dramatic reading

Description		Mark
Reads poem aloud with good volume and pace; projects voice; reads fluently and pronounces words correctly. Excellent rap and acting skills.		8-10
Reads poem aloud, with some mistakes in pronunciation; makes use of volume and pace; lots of pauses and tends to stop before every word (not fluent). Rap and acting skills not too bad.		4-7
Many mistakes in pronunciation; makes little or no use of volume and pace; learner is almost unable to decode (sound out) words correctly; very little or no rap and acting skills.		0-3
PROCESSED MARK	10÷10X25	



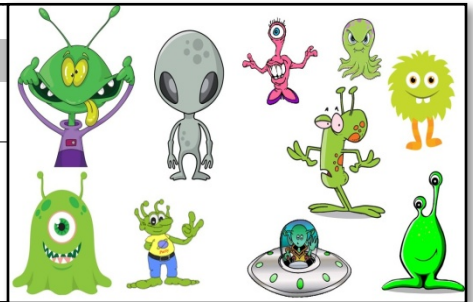
DATE: _____

TOPIC: OUT OF THIS WORLD

Activity 9: WRITING AND PRESENTING

CONTENT

- Complete a poem.
- Write own poem.



9.1 Use the correct line in the box to complete a poem.

No one has discovered them **yet**.

Some might even know how to ride a **bike**.

Most aliens act really **bad**.

Some might even know the **queen**.

Most of them are really **sly**.

Aliens are strange; you will never know what they are **like**,

Some are blue some are **green**.

Aliens often go very **mad**,

I think that Aliens could maybe **fly**,

Some are dry some are **wet**,

9.2 Write your own poem about aliens.



DATE: _____

TOPIC: OUT OF THIS WORLD

Activity 10: LANGUAGE STRUCTURES & CONVENTIONS

CONTENT

- Introduce proper nouns.
- Underline proper nouns in a text.
- Use proper nouns in a sentence

Refresher!

Nouns are words that name people, places, things or ideas.

Common nouns name people, places, things or ideas that are **not specific** like woman, city, dog, shoe.

Since these nouns aren't naming anything specific, they don't need to start with a capital letter unless they begin a sentence.

Let's look at proper nouns

Proper nouns name **specific** people, places, things or ideas

Lerato, **Durban**, **Woolworths**

Since these nouns are naming specific things, they always begin with a capital letter.

10.1 Specific names for people, places or things



The name of our country.
South Africa

Proper Nouns

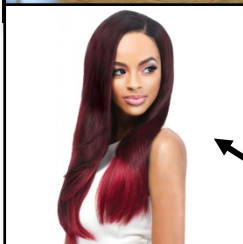


The name of a car.
Ford

The name of a store.
Checkers



The name of a restaurant.
Nando's

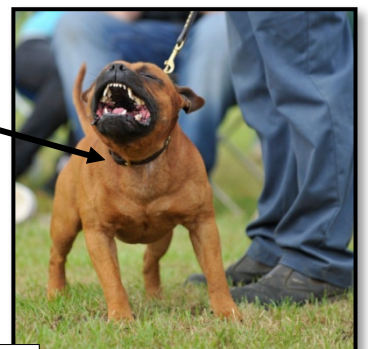


The name of a woman.
Nomsa

The name of a bank.
Capitec



The name of a dog.
Pit-bull



The name of a city.
Johannesburg
Joburg



10.2 Choose five proper nouns on page 28 and write sentences.

DATE: _____

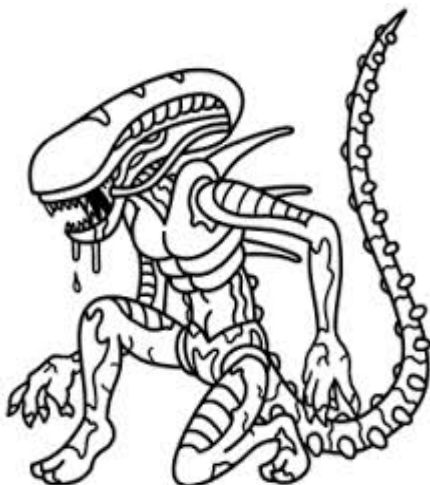
TOPIC (3): TELLING TALES

Activity 11: LISTENING AND SPEAKING

CONTENT

- Take part in discussion.
- Draw a picture.
- Participate in shared reading.

11.1 Have a discussion on what aliens look like, what they eat, wear, and their entertainment. Give reasons.



INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3



11.2 Picture dictation:

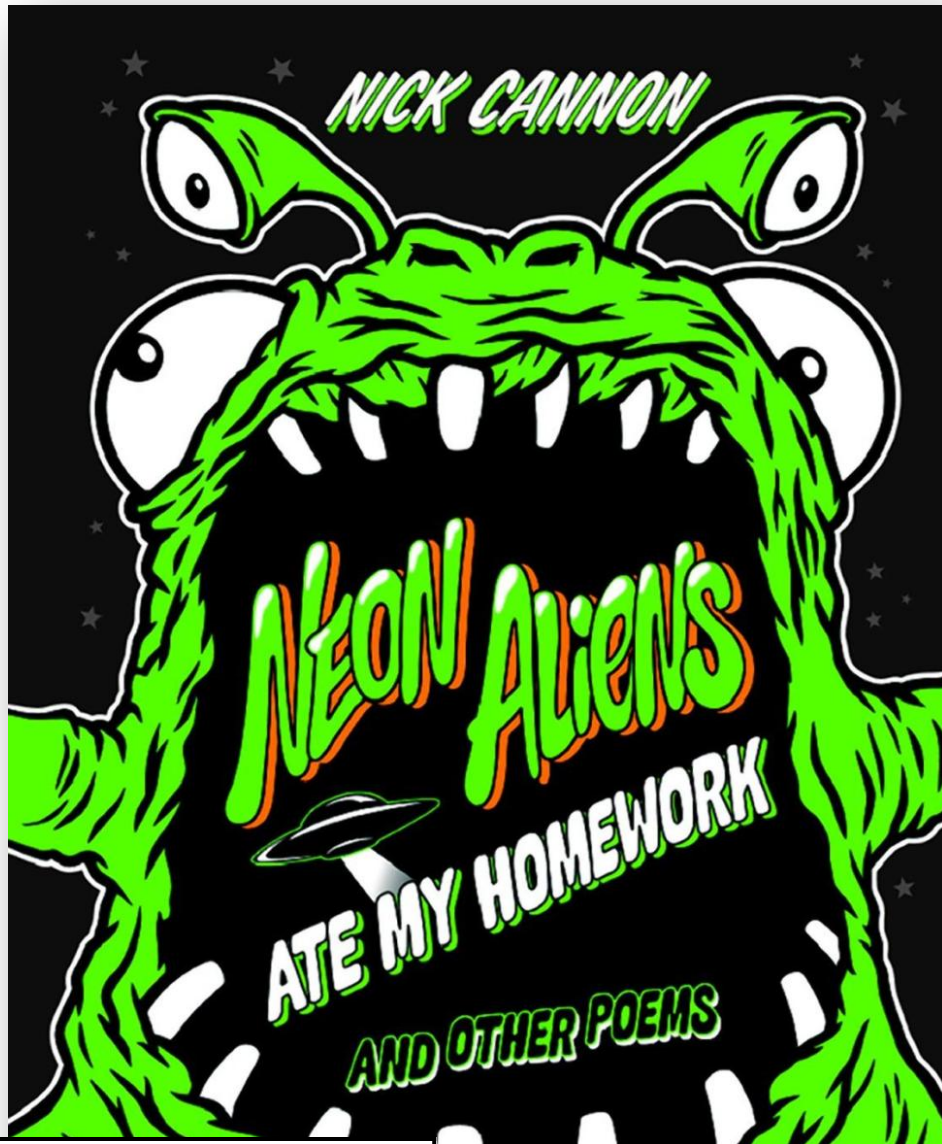
Listen carefully and draw what you hear your teacher describes.



Activity 12: READING AND VIEWING

CONTENT

- Do shared reading on a poem and prepare for a formal assessment task.



Neon

a colourless gas, one of the chemical elements, that is often used in signs because it produces a **bright light** when an electric current goes through it: a **neon** sign.

Alien

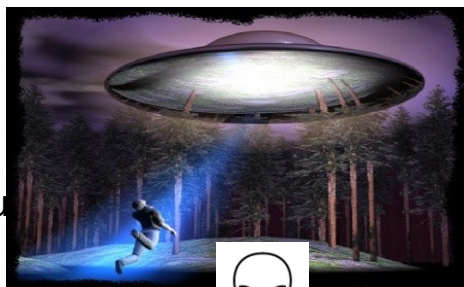
a hypothetical or fictional being from another world.

NEON ALIENS ATE MY HOMEWORK

Okay, I know this sounds totally berserk,

But last night neon aliens ate my homework!
They zoomed down right above my home
And zapped me up inside their dome.
These little green guys glowed brightly in the dark,
Their dripping fangs snapped with the force of a shark.
I was scared out of my wits not knowing my fate.
Thinking to myself, *I'm gonna be next on their plate!*
What would satisfy the hunger of these guys?
Would they leave me alone if they heard my cries?
I offered them my notebook and even my backpack.
I feared they could make me disappear with a ZIP ZAP!

The aliens weren't done; they still wanted something to eat.
So I took out my totally finished language worksheet.
That did the trick, and they sent me home without warning.
When I got back, it was eight o'clock the next morning.
I ran in the house and cried for my mom.
She hugged me tight and told me to keep calm.
Mom said, "Just tell your teacher the whole story.
She'll understand what happened – don't you worry.
Alien invasions are common in this nation,
And so are kids with fantastic imaginations."



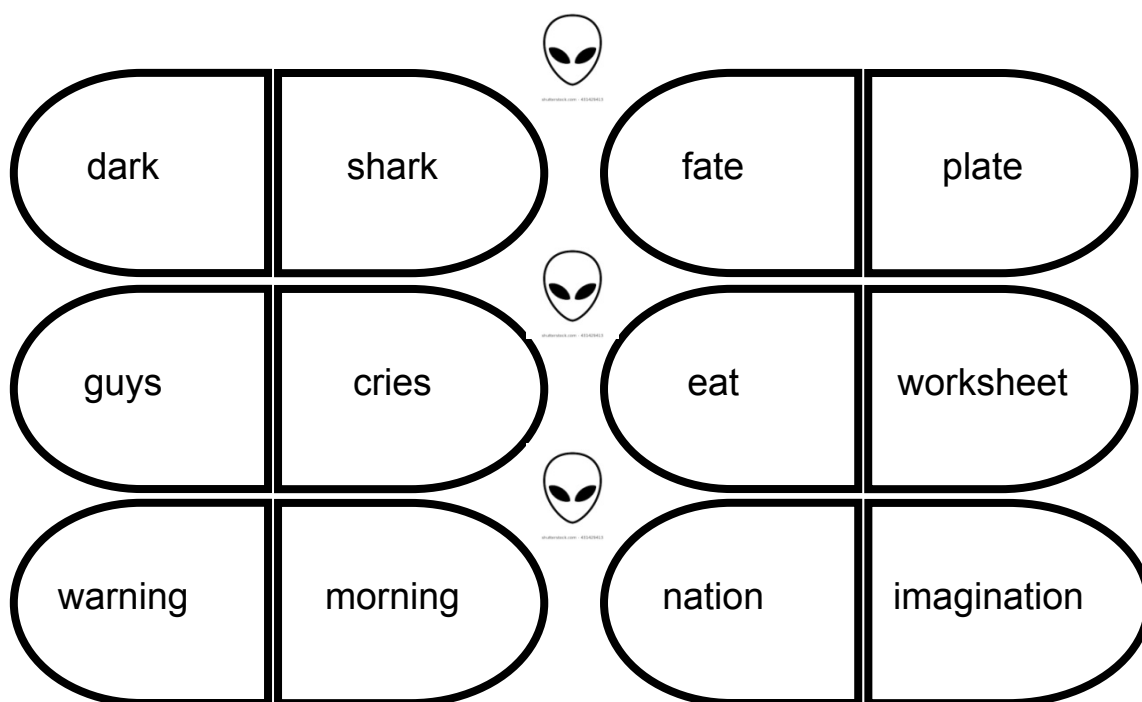
12.2 Practise pronouncing the words correctly.

berserk

homework

home

dome



12.3 Practise: Reading skills and correct pronunciation.

These little green guys glowed brightly in the dark,
Their dripping fangs snapped with the force of a shark.

I was scared out of my wits not knowing my fate.
Thinking to myself, *I'm gonna be next on their plate!*

What would satisfy the hunger of these guys?
Would they leave me alone if they heard my cries?

DATE: _____

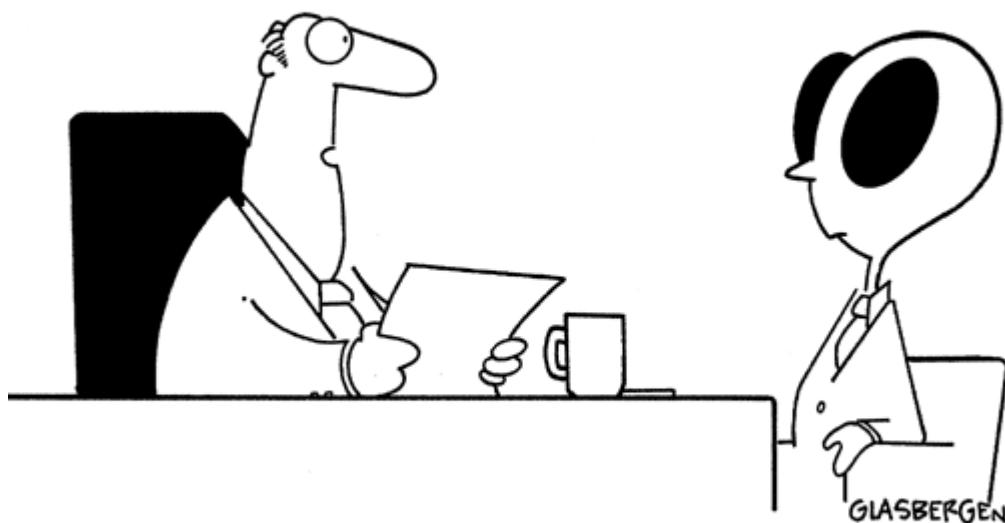
TOPIC: TELLING TALES

Activity 13: WRITING AND PRESENTING

CONTENT

- Work in pairs and write questions and answers.

MEETING AN ALIEN



- 13.1 Make up a role play with your friend in which you interview an alien from outer space. Ask your friend questions starting with the words below.

What

Why

When

Where

Who

How

- 13.2 Now fill in your questions and the alien's answers.



INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

You	The alien
What 	
Where 	
Why 	
When 	
Who 	
How 	

DATE: _____

TOPIC: TELLING TALES

Activity 14: LANGUAGE STRUCTURES AND CONVENTIONS

CONTENT

- Write sentences.

Refresher!

Verbs are doing words.

Adjectives are describing words. Adjectives describe nouns.

Let's look at adverbs

Adverb:

A word that describes **a_verb**, **an adjective**, or another **adverb**.

Example:

- She **drives** carefully.
How does she drive? describes a verb
- She's a very **good** driver.
How good a driver is she? describes an adjective
- She drives really **well**.
How well does she drive? describes another adverb

14.1 Complete each sentence using the adverbs from the list.
Underline the verb the adverb describes. (12)

slowly always quickly lovingly here when

- 14.1.1 Alien turtles move _____ .
- 14.1.2 _____ did the aliens arrive in their space ship?
- 14.1.3 They have not been _____ before.
- 14.1.4 I saw the space ship and ran home _____.
- 14.1.5 The alien held the cat _____.
- 14.1.6 You must _____ report space ship sightings.

DATE: _____

TOPIC(4): LOOKING AT LANGUAGE

Activity 15: LANGUAGE STRUCTURES AND CONVENTIONS

CONTENT

- Nouns
- Adjectives
- Verbs
- Adverbs

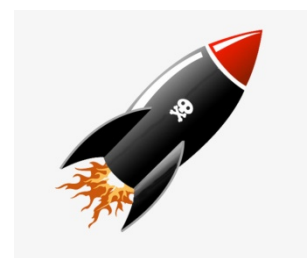
Sort the underlined words into the correct columns.

Last night neon aliens quickly started a blazing fire. They zoomed down right above my quiet home and rapidly fired their missiles into the dark

forest. These little green guys glowed brightly in the dark and their dripping fangs snapped loudly with the force of a hungry shark.

Nouns	Adjectives	Verbs	Adverbs
8	7	4	4

Mark any 20 of 23: (20)



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Here are quotes from 4 of the 12 ways our phones are changing us.

1. Addicted to Distraction

If you're a typical American, you check your smartphone an average of every 4.3 minutes. That's 81,500 times a year.

Facebook? 70% of people check it daily (over one billion others around the world do the same!). On Facebook, Messenger, and Instagram alone, we spend at least 50 minutes a day.

Why are we so addicted? Reinke suggests we use digital distractions to keep work away, keep people away, or keep thoughts of eternity away.

2. Ignore Flesh and Blood

While I often use my phone to connect with flesh and blood people, I don't want it to replace in-person encounters. Given the choice, face-to-face beats digital.

"We become content to 'LOL' with our thumbs or to cry emoticon tears to express our sorrow because we cannot (and will not) take the time to genuinely invest ourselves in real tears of sorrow. We use our phones to multitask our emotions."
And in the car? Let's please stop checking our phones while driving. It's killing us.

"Talking on the phone while driving a vehicle makes you four times more likely to get into an accident, but texting while driving makes your chance of a crash twenty-three times more likely."

3. Lose Our Literacy

Reinke points out that a few people actually read more books as a result of online interactions. (He is also the author of [Lit! A Christian Guide to Reading Books](#), one of my [favorite books I read in 2012](#).)

But more commonly, smartphone users read fewer books now.

"It can be said that literacy has fallen to such a degree that, for many Christians today (perhaps most Christians today), the Bible stands as the oldest, longest, and most complicated book we will ever try to read on our own."

Plus, reading digitally teaches us to scan at fast speeds. Can we train ourselves to read online text slower?

4. Fear of Missing Out

Do you know what nomophobia is? No-mobile-phone phobia. FOMO (fear of missing out) hits us on two sides: anxiety that we're not staying updated on

information if we're not checking our phone, and insecurity of not getting the affirmation we want if we're offline.

"This desire for personal affirmation is perhaps the smartphone's strongest lure, and it is only amplified when we feel the sting of loneliness or suffering in our lives. At the first hint of discomfort, we instinctively grab our phones to medicate the pain with affirmation. This habit could not be more damaging."

Suggestions

Along with the bad news, Reinke also gives lots of suggestions in the book for ways to live smarter with our smartphones. (He doesn't say get rid of them altogether; he's no technophobe.)

These include:

1. Turn off all nonessential push notifications.
2. Delete expired, nonessential, and time-wasting apps.
3. Use a real alarm clock, not your phone alarm, to keep the phone out of your hands in the morning.
4. Guard your morning disciplines and evening sleep patterns by using phone settings to mute notifications between one hour before bedtime to a time when you can reasonably expect to be finished with personal disciplines in the morning (9 p.m. to 7 a.m., for example).
5. Recognize that much of what you respond to quickly can wait. Respond at a later, more convenient time.

Ask Your Family

Are you brave enough to take this suggestion?

"Invite your spouse, your friends, and your family members to offer feedback on your phone habits (more than 70 percent of Christians in my survey said nobody else knew how much time they spent online)."

Our phone use affects others in more ways than we realize.

"If I'm a social-media junkie, my lack of self-control feeds the social-media addiction in you. And the more I text and tweet and Snapchat, the more I drag you and others into the digital vortex of reciprocating obligation. . . ."

Even something as simple as pulling out your smartphone in a crowd is ‘the new yawn’—everyone else around you will feel the immediate pull and lure to check their own phones.”

I highly recommend this book. We all can benefit by periodically evaluating why we are using our phones.

“Apps can help me stay focused on my Bible reading plans and help me organize my prayer life, but no app can breathe life into my communion with God. . . . What shall it profit a man if he gains all the latest digital devices and all of the techniques of touch-screen mastery but loses his own soul?”

* * *

How do you use your phone the most? Calls? Texts? Apps? [Please share your thoughts here.](#)

[Read the preface and introduction here of *12 Ways Your Phone Is Changing You*.](#)

Related:

- [Where Is Your Phone Right Now?](#)
- [Should You Get Off Facebook?](#)
- [Unfollow a Friend on Facebook to Keep a Friend](#)
- Book: [The Happiness Effect: How Social Media is Driving a Generation to Appear Perfect at Any Cost by Donna Freitas](#)

One suggestion you gave in the comments that day (thanks, Lynn Morrissey) was to read the new book by Tony Reinke, [12 Ways Your Phone Is Changing You](#).

Signs and Symptoms of Cell Phone Addiction

Although cell phone addiction is not yet listed in the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, 5th Edition (DSM-5), research has compared it to gambling addiction, which has clearer diagnostic criteria and is included in the DSM-5.

At least 4 of the following signs and symptoms are thought to comprise criteria for cell phone addiction, and the problematic cell phone overuse must cause significant harm in the individual's life:^{2,3}

- **A need to use the cell phone more** and more often in order to achieve the same desired effect.
- Persistent **failed attempts to use cell phone less often**.
- **Preoccupation** with smartphone use.
- Turns to cell phone when experiencing unwanted feelings such as anxiety or depression.
- **Excessive use** characterized by loss of sense of time.
- Has put a **relationship or job at risk** due to excessive cell phone use.
- **Tolerance**.
 - Need for newest cell phone, more applications, or increased use.
- **Withdrawal**, when cell phone or network is unreachable.
 - Anger.
 - Tension.
 - Depression.
 - Irritability.
 - Restlessness.

If you or a loved one displays these signs and symptoms of cell phone addiction, help is readily available. Call the phone number above to speak with a treatment specialist about various recovery options.

Physical Effects of Addiction

Overuse of your cell phone or smartphone can result in a number of different physical problems that may cause permanent damage or be difficult to treat, including:



- **Digital eye strain.**⁴
 - The pain and discomfort associated with viewing a digital screen for over 2 hours.
 - Eyes begin to burn and itch.
 - Blurred vision.
 - Eye fatigue.
 - Digital Eye Strain can cause headaches.
- **Neck problems.**
 - Also known as “text neck,” which refers to neck pain resulting from looking down at cell phone or tablet for too long.⁵
- **Increased illnesses** due to germs.⁶
 - 1 in 6 cell phones has fecal matter on it.
 - E. coli bacteria, which can cause fever, vomiting, and diarrhea, is found on many phones.
 - Phones have been found to be contaminated with MRSA.
 - Causes painful abscesses.
 - Life-threatening infections in bones, joints, surgical wounds, bloodstream, heart valves, and lungs.
- **Car accidents.**

- Many people believe that they can multitask and use their phones while driving, but this causes significant impairment and puts the driver and others on the road in danger.
 - Research has revealed that **texting and driving can be just as dangerous as drinking and driving.**⁷
 - **Male infertility.**
 - Preliminary studies have revealed that cell phone radiation may decrease sperm count, sperm motility and viability.⁸
-

Psychological Effects of Cell Phone Addiction

- **Sleep disturbances.**⁹
 - Cell phone addiction has been linked to an increase in sleep disorders and fatigue in users.
 - Using your cell phone before bed increases the likelihood of insomnia.
 - Bright light may decrease sleep quality.
 - Smartphone use could increase amount of time it takes to fall asleep.
 - Light emitted from the cell phone may activate the brain.
- **Depression.**¹⁰
- **Obsessive Compulsive Disorder.**¹⁰
- **Relationship problems.**
 - Offline relationships may suffer as a result of neglect in favor of excessive cell phone and social media use.¹¹
- **Anxiety.**

- Research has found that college students who use their cell phones the most are more likely to feel anxious during downtime.¹²
-

Am I Addicted to my Smartphone?

This self-assessment is not meant to officially diagnose you with cell phone addiction. If you are concerned about your problematic behaviors, speak to your doctor or mental health professional about possible treatment.¹³

1. Do you find yourself spending more time on your smartphone than you realize?
2. Do you find yourself mindlessly passing time on a regular basis by staring at your smartphone even though there might be better or more productive things to do?
3. Do you seem to lose track of time when on your cell phone?
4. Do you find yourself spending more time texting, tweeting, or emailing as opposed to talking to real-time people?
5. Has the amount of time you spend on your cell phone been increasing?
6. Do you secretly wish you could be a little less wired or connected to your cell phone?
7. Do you sleep with your smartphone on or under your pillow or next to your bed regularly?
8. Do you find yourself viewing and answering texts, tweets, and emails at all hours of the day and night, even when it means interrupting other things you are doing?

9. Do you text, email, tweet, or surf the internet while driving or doing other similar activities that require your focused attention and concentration?
 10. Do you feel your use of your cell phone actually decreases your productivity at times?
 11. Do you feel reluctant to be without your smartphone, even for a short time?
 12. When you leave the house, you ALWAYS have your smartphone with you and you feel ill-at-ease or uncomfortable when you accidentally leave your smartphone in the car or at home, or you have no service, or it is broken?
 13. When you eat meals, is your cell phone always part of the table place setting?
 14. When your phone rings, beeps, buzzes, do you feel an intense urge to check for texts, tweets, or emails, updates, etc.?
 15. Do you find yourself mindlessly checking your phone many times a day even when you know there is likely nothing new or important to see?
- 



The smartphone
is causing a
social reversal:
the desire to be
alone in public
and never alone
in seclusion.

TONY REINKE

1	We Are Addicted to Distraction	41
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AN EXAMPLE OF THE ESSAY

Mobile phone is a good technology which is not lacking from our lives. It has changed the cultures and habits of the people over the world.

Today, mobile phone has become popular to everybody since it is very convenient. The most advantage of having a mobile phone is you can communicate to your family and your friends no matter what where you are.

Some problems that can come from text messaging or other instant messaging devices are:

- Lack of attention to surroundings and people around
- Having lengthy text conversations rather than in person talks
- No need for face to face social skills
- Too attached to cellphones

"Texting on a daily basis makes it easy to avoid speaking with people on the phone. We never have to deal with minimizing face time."

The Problems with

Children under effect

- Children prefer mobile activity instead of play physically.
- Discounted cell phone accessories have made it easier for children to buy them and keep them unnoticed!
- Use in inappropriate places causes disturbance, such as in classrooms.
- A recent study in USA shows that a teen sends average 400 text messages per week. About half of them are sent during class hours.





Text Messaging

Text messaging has also caused problems with social issues in people. Much similar to messaging people online texts can have the same detachment from reality and in some cases make it hard for people to hold actual conversations face to face.

SMARTPHONES *are the* NEW CIGARETTES *and here's why...*

They're **SUPER** addicting



They cost a **TON**



It's **ANNOYING** when people use them in public

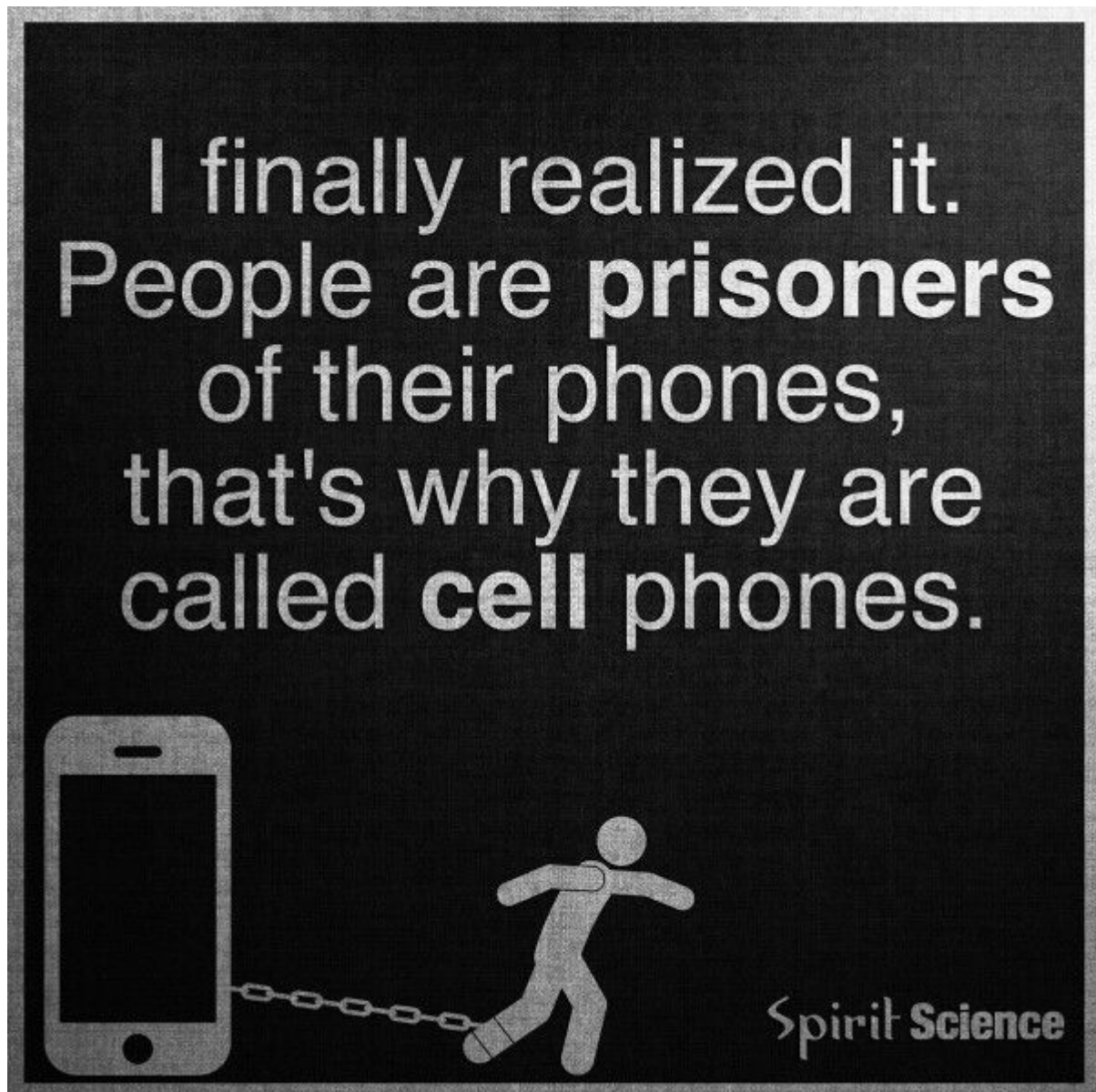


They'll probably give us all **CANCER**



Conclusion

- In conclusion, technology is slowly destroying the minds of teenagers through their physical and mental health. Also their quality of human interaction is slowly fading.
- The Structural-Functionalist Perspective main is how illness, health, and health care affect and are affected by changes in other aspects of social life. This theory is shown throughout the presentation and how it deals with technology and the minds of teenagers.



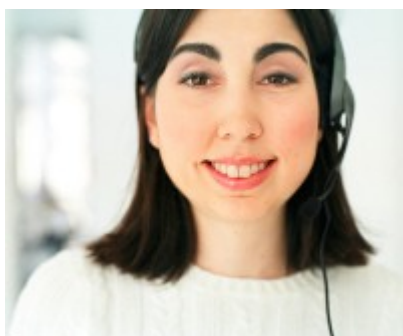
INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

Rubric to assess a discussion

Listening and speaking 30 marks	Level 4	Level 3	Level 2	Level 1
	8-10	6-7	4-5	1-3
Participation in debate	Skilfully sustains a conversation; listens to others with respect; takes turns; justifies own point of view; shows excellent understanding of the topic	Takes part in the discussion; listens to others with respect; takes a point of view and sometimes justifies it; takes turns; shows understanding of the topic	Takes part in the discussion adequately; able to listen and follow; few interruptions of others; defends viewpoint adequately; shows some understanding of the topic	Takes little or no part in the discussion; does not listen to others; or frequently interrupts; does not follow the thread of the debat; does not take a viewpoint
Ability to express self orally	Expresses her/himself very well. Able to say what he/she wants to say clearly and easily with few or no mistakes.	Expresses him/herself well. Able to say what he/she wants to say clearly and fairly easily, but with some mistakes.	Expresses him/herself with some difficulty. Struggles to say what he/she wants to say and makes many mistakes.	Struggles to express him/herself orally. Makes many mistakes. Difficult to understand. Says only one or two words.
Voice projection and modulation	Excellent	Very good	Poor	Hampers communication
TOTAL	30			



Tips for the Receptionist or Secretary



Presenting a professional image, both in person and on the telephone, is very important in the Office Skills profession. Taking care of your customers over the telephone and making them feel well informed and appreciated is essential. Whether you are the front office receptionist or an executive secretary, the following phone tips should always be followed.

1. Speak clearly. A picture paints a thousand words but the caller on the other end of the phone can only hear you. They cannot see your face or body language. Therefore, taking the time to speak clearly, slowly and in a cheerful, professional voice is very important.
2. Use your normal tone of voice when answering a call. If you have a tendency to speak loud or shout, avoid doing so on the telephone.
3. Do not eat or drink while you are on telephone duty. Only eat or drink during your coffee break or lunch break.

INFORMAL TASKS (YEAR 3)
TERM 3

4. Do not use slang words or Poor Language. Respond clearly with “yes” or “no” when speaking. Never use swear words.
5. Address the Caller Properly by his or her title. (i.e. Good morning Mr. Brown, Good afternoon Ms. Sanders). Never address an unfamiliar caller by his or her first name.
6. Listen to the Caller and what they have to say. The ability to listen is a problem in general but it is very important to listen to what the caller has to say. It is always a good habit to repeat the information back to the client when you are taking a message. Verify that you have heard and transcribed the message accurately.
7. Be patient and helpful. If a caller is irate or upset, listen to what they have to say and then refer them to the appropriate resource. Never snap back or act rude to the caller.
8. Always ask if you can put the caller on hold. If you are responsible for answering multiple calls at once, always ask the caller politely if you may put them on hold. Remember that the caller could have already waited several minutes before getting connected to you and may not take lightly to being put on hold. Never leave the person on hold for more than a few seconds or they may become upset and hang up.
9. Always focus on the call. Try not to get distracted by people around you. If someone tries to interrupt you while you are on a call, politely remind them that you are on a customer call and that you will be with them as soon as you are finished.

Making Calls



1. Always identify yourself properly. When calling a client or customer, whether in person or when leaving a message, always identify yourself properly by providing your name, company name and contact telephone number. For example, "Good afternoon Mr. Brown, this is Ms. Brown from Officeskills.org. My telephone number is 408-555-1212." Always be aware of confidential information when leaving messages. Also, be aware of people around you while talking on the phone. Be discreet! Someone next to you might overhear confidential information that could negatively affect your business.
2. Avoid leaving long winded messages. Remember, someone has to listen to your message, write it down and then act upon it. Your message may be just one of many messages that need to be handled. It is often a good habit to write down or type out your message in advance. Keep it brief and to the point.

